

The Complete Housing Guide for Nepali Students

2025 – 2026 Edition | Cities: Seoul · Busan · Daegu · Daejeon · Incheon

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■ Introduction — Why This Guide Exists

South Korea is rapidly becoming one of the most popular study destinations for Nepali students, with over **6,000 Nepali students** enrolled in Korean universities as of 2024. The country offers world-class universities, affordable tuition compared to Western countries, a vibrant cultural environment, and a growing Nepali community. However, finding safe and affordable housing remains one of the biggest challenges — especially for first-time arrivals who face language barriers, an unfamiliar rental system, and very real risks of deposit loss.

This guide is written specifically for Nepali students. It covers every housing type available, city-by-city breakdowns, all platforms and apps you can use, critical warnings about landlord deposit deductions (a very common problem for international students), and step-by-step legal protection advice. Read it before you sign *anything*.

■ Understanding South Korea's Unique Rental System

Korea's rental system is **completely different** from Nepal's. Before anything else, you must understand these three systems:

Rental Type	Korean Term	How It Works	Typical Cost (KRW)	NPR Equivalent	Best For
Full Deposit (No Monthly Rent)	Jeonse (전세)	Pay a huge lump-sum deposit (50–70% of property value). No monthly rent. Deposit fully returned at end of lease (usually 2 years).	■50M–■200M+	NPR 5Cr–20Cr+	Long-term residents with large capital. NOT recommended for students.
Mixed Deposit + Monthly Rent	Banjeonse (반전세)	Medium deposit + reduced monthly rent. Common in officetels.	■10M–■30M deposit + ■300K–■600K/month	NPR ~1Cr deposit + NPR 30K–60K/month	Students staying 1–2 years with some savings.
Monthly Rent	Wolse (월세)	Smaller deposit + full monthly rent. Most common for students.	■1M–■10M deposit + ■300K–■700K/month	NPR 10K–1Lakh deposit + NPR 30K–70K/month	BEST for most Nepali students. Most flexible.

Gosiwon / Goshiwon	■■■	Tiny private room (6–10 sqm) in a shared facility. All bills included. No big deposit.	■200K–■500K/month. Deposit ■100K–■500K only.	NPR 20K–50K/month	Budget-conscious students needing minimal commitment.
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■■ JEONSE WARNING FOR NEPALI STUDENTS

Jeonse fraud is a MAJOR crisis in South Korea. Between 2022–2024, nearly 20,000 cases of failed Jeonse refunds were recorded. Landlords collect deposits and invest them — then cannot return the money. As a Nepali student, AVOID Jeonse completely. Stick to Wolse (monthly rent) or Gosiwon.

Essential Korean Terms Every Nepali Student Must Know

■■■ Bojungeum	Security deposit. This is what you pay upfront and get back at the end (minus any deductions).
■■ Wolse	Monthly rent payment. You pay this every month on top of the deposit.
■■■ Gwallibi	Monthly building management fee (■20,000–■200,000). Covers elevator, cleaning, sometimes water/internet.
■■■ Budongsan	Real estate agency / agent office. Every neighbourhood has several.
■■ Bokbi	Agent commission fee. Usually 0.3–0.9% of deposit value. Paid to the Budongsan.
■■ Won-room	Studio apartment — one combined living/sleeping room, small kitchen, private bathroom. Most common student housing.
■■■ Gosiwon	Tiny shared-facility room. No big deposit, bills included. Ultra-budget option.
■■■■ Officetel	Mixed commercial-residential building. Modern amenities but higher management fees.
■■ Villa	Low-rise 2–5 floor residential building. Cheaper management fees than officetels.
■■■■■ Deungi-bu Deungbon	Certified Property Register — ALWAYS check before paying any deposit.
■■■■ Hwakjeong-ilja	Fixed Date Stamp — register at the local community center on move-in day to legally protect your deposit.
■■■■ Jumin Senteo	Local community center — for address registration, fixed date stamp, and general help.

■ All Types of Student Accommodation in Korea

1. University Dormitory (■■■)

- Safest and easiest option for new arrivals.
- Utilities and internet usually included in the fee.
- Built-in social network — you'll meet fellow international students immediately.
- Typical cost: ■200,000–■500,000/month (NPR ~20,000–50,000).
- ■ CONS: Limited availability — apply the moment you receive your admission letter. Must vacate during semester breaks. Strict curfew and house rules. Less privacy.
- ■ Nepali tip: Contact your university's international office within 48 hours of getting your acceptance. Dorm spots fill up extremely fast, especially at popular universities.

2. Gosiwon / Goshiwon (■■■)

- Tiny private room (6–10 sqm) in a shared facility with communal kitchen and bathrooms.
- ALL utilities (water, electricity, internet, sometimes gas) are included in the monthly fee.
- No large deposit required — usually only ■100,000–■500,000.
- Monthly rent: ■200,000–■500,000/month (NPR ~20,000–50,000). Cheapest private housing in Korea.
- Most buildings have washing machines, shared refrigerators, and 24-hour access.
- ■ CONS: Very small rooms. Can feel isolating. Limited cooking facilities. Thin walls.
- ■ Nepali tip: A gosiwon is the BEST first-step option if you arrive without a long-term plan. Stay for 1–2 months while you find a better place.

3. One-Room Studio (■■)

- Most popular housing for independent Nepali students.
- Private studio with own bathroom, small kitchen, and living/sleeping area.
- Deposit (Bojungeum): ■1,000,000–■10,000,000. Monthly rent: ■300,000–■700,000.
- In NPR: Deposit ~NPR 1 lakh–10 lakh. Monthly ~NPR 30,000–70,000.
- Management fee (Gwallibi) of ■30,000–■100,000/month is extra.

- Villas (■■■) are cheaper than Officetels (■■■■■) — choose villa to save ■50,000–■150,000/month on management fees.
- ■■ CONS: Responsible for all utility bills. Can be isolated if you don't know the area.
- ■■ Nepali tip: Target villas 1–2 subway stops from your university for the best price-to-convenience ratio.

4. Shared Apartment / Flatshare

- Rent a room in a larger apartment shared with other students.
- Each person pays a share of rent and utilities.
- Typical cost per person: ■200,000–■450,000/month — significantly cheaper than a solo studio.
- Platforms: Facebook groups, Peter Pan (■■■■), University bulletin boards.
- GREAT for Nepali students who want to live with other Nepali or South Asian students.
- ■■ CONS: Shared management of bills. Potential conflict over chores, noise, guests.
- ■■ Nepali tip: Join SONSIK (Society of Nepalese Students in Korea) Facebook group — many students post flatshare opportunities there.

5. Purpose-Built Student Accommodation (PBSA)

- Modern student-only buildings with amenities like study rooms, gyms, laundry.
- Low or zero traditional Korean deposit structures — more accessible for international students.
- Platforms: Student.com, AmberStudent, Uniplaces, HousingAnywhere.
- Monthly cost: ■500,000–■900,000 — premium but transparent pricing.
- English contracts, English-speaking staff, designed for international students.
- ■■ CONS: Expensive. Fills up very fast. Less immersive Korean experience.
- ■■ Nepali tip: Book 3–4 months before arrival from Nepal via Student.com or AmberStudent.

6. Homestay

- Live with a Korean family in their home.
- Often includes meals (breakfast and/or dinner).
- Cost: ■500,000–■900,000/month including meals.
- EXCELLENT for Korean language learning.
- Some universities have official homestay programs — ask your international office.

- ■ CONS: Less independence. Must follow household rules.
- ■ Nepali tip: Contact your university's international office specifically about homestay programmes — they often maintain vetted family lists.

■ All Ways to Find a Room — Complete Platform Guide

A. Korean Real Estate Apps (Download on Android/iOS)

App / Platform	Korean Name	Best For	Key Warning
Zigbang	■■	Largest listing volume. Map-based filtering. Filter by deposit, rent, and area.	'Ghost listings' (Heoweul maemul ■■■■) used as price bait. Always call before visiting.
Dabang	■■	3D room tours. Granular filters for management fees, utilities, and furnishing.	Verify price directly with broker. Some listings are outdated.
Naver Real Estate	■■■ ■■■	Official Naver platform. More verified listings. Good for price comparison.	Interface is entirely in Korean — use Google Translate or a Korean-speaking friend.
Peter Pan	■■■■ ■■■ ■■■	Direct tenant-to-tenant transfers. NO agent commission fee (Bokbi). Great for finding rooms from departing students.	Verify the person is a real current tenant. Meet in person before any payment.
Gosiwon.kr	■■■■■	Korea's largest gosiwon search platform. Filter by city, price, included amenities.	Room sizes vary a lot. View in person — photos can be misleading.

B. Foreigner-Friendly Platforms (English Support — HIGHLY Recommended for Nepali Students)

Platform	Key Feature	Deposit Situation	Website
Checkmate Korea	English contracts. Physical accompaniment to real estate offices. Ongoing support for trash/maintenance issues.	Standard Korean deposit. Agent helps protect you.	checkmatekorea.com
Enkostay	Specialises in zero-to-low deposit structures designed for international students. Deposit protection built-in.	LOW or ZERO deposit. Best for students with limited capital.	stay.enko.kr
Ziptoss	Corporate agency with certified English and Chinese-speaking agents. Lower ghost listing risk.	Standard. Corporate verification reduces fraud risk.	ziptoss.com

Student.com	Global platform. Pre-verified international student accommodation with clear payment terms bookable from Nepal.	Flexible — often no traditional Korean deposit.	student.com
AmberStudent	Pre-verified PBSA listings. Book before arriving. English support.	Transparent pricing from abroad.	amberstudent.com
HousingAnywhere	Mid-term rental platform. International focus. Secure payment system.	Payments held securely until move-in.	housinganywhere.com

C. Nepali Community Channels & Social Media

SONSIK Facebook Page	Society of Nepalese Students in Korea — the official Nepali student organization. ~12,000 members. Post your housing needs here first.
Nepalese Community in Busan (NCB)	Facebook group specifically for Busan-based Nepali community. Great for Busan housing leads.
KakaoTalk Group Chats	Korea's main messaging app. Join KakaoTalk open chats for your university's Nepali/international students. Ask seniors for room leads.
Facebook: 'Nepali Students in South Korea'	General Facebook group. Post your requirements — many seniors post available rooms when they are leaving Korea.
Facebook: 'Housing in Busan / Seoul'	City-specific English-language housing Facebook groups. Active listings, some ghost listings — always verify.
University International Office Bulletin Boards	Physical and online boards with rooms offered by verified landlords or departing students.
Your University's Nepali Student Association	Almost every major Korean university has a Nepali student club. Contact them BEFORE you arrive — they know available rooms.

D. Walking into Budongsan (Real Estate Agent) Offices In Person

Once you arrive in Korea, the most effective method is to walk directly into a Budongsan (부동산) office near your university. This is how most Korean students find rooms. Here is how to do it:

- Use Google Maps to search '부동산' or 'real estate' near your university — you will find many offices within walking distance.
- If possible, bring a Korean-speaking friend, your university's international buddy, or use a translation app (Papago or Google Translate).

- Show the agent your budget, desired move-in date, and preferred room size. They will show you multiple options.
- You will pay a Bokbi (■■■) commission fee — typically 0.3–0.9% of the deposit. This is normal and legal.
- Never pay anything to the agent before signing a contract. The commission is paid at signing.
- Ask specifically for 'villa' (■■■) options to save on management fees vs 'officetel' (■■■■■).

■ City-by-City Housing Guide for Nepali Students

■ SEOUL — Most Expensive, Most Nepali Students

Seoul has the largest concentration of Nepali students in Korea, particularly around Sinchon, Hongdae, and the university districts. Costs are 20–40% higher than other Korean cities.

Neighbourhood	Key Universities Nearby	Typical One-Room Deposit	Typical Monthly Rent	NPR Monthly Budget
Sinchon / Hongdae (■■■■·■■■)	Yonsei, Ewha, Sogang, Hongik	■3M–■10M	■500K–■800K	NPR 50K–80K
Gwanak-gu (■■■■) — Sillim Area	Seoul National University (SNU)	■1M–■5M	■350K–■600K	NPR 35K–60K
Dongdaemun-gu (■■■■■) — Hoegi	HUFS, Kyung Hee, Univ of Seoul	■1M–■5M	■350K–■600K	NPR 35K–60K
Nowon-gu / Dobong-gu (■■·■■■■)	Korea Nat'l Univ of Arts, Univ of Seoul	■1M–■4M	■300K–■500K	NPR 30K–50K
Seodaemun-gu / Mapo-gu Budget Villas	2 stops from Hongdae/Sinchon	■1M–■3M	■300K–■500K	NPR 30K–50K

■ Seoul-Specific Tips

Ziptoss (Sinchon & Hongdae branches) specialises in Yonsei, Ewha, and Sogang international students. Craigslist Seoul Housing section also has English-speaking local brokers. For budget Seoul living, target villas 2 subway stops from your campus — saves 10–20% on rent.

■ BUSAN — 2nd City, Significantly More Affordable, Growing Nepali Community

Busan is ideal for Nepali students studying at PNU, Kyungsung, Pukyong, or Dong-A University. Rents are 20–35% lower than Seoul, rooms are larger, and the city has a vibrant coastal atmosphere. The Nepalese Community in Busan (NCB) Facebook group is active and very helpful.

Neighbourhood	Key Universities	Typical One-Room Deposit	Typical Monthly Rent	NPR Monthly Budget
Geumjeong-gu — PNU Area (■■■)	Pusan National University (PNU)	■1M–■5M	■300K–■550K	NPR 30K–55K

Nam-gu — Kyungsung Area (■■)	Kyungsung, Pukyong National	■1M–■4M	■280K–■500K	NPR 28K–50K
Busanjin-gu — Seomyeon (■■■■)	Central transit hub. Good for multiple universities.	■2M–■8M	■400K–■700K	NPR 40K–70K
Sasang-gu (■■■)	Dong-A University, affordable area	■500K–■3M	■250K–■450K	NPR 25K–45K

Government-Designated Foreigner-Friendly Real Estate Agencies in Busan:

GeumDon Real Estate (■■ ■■■)	Geumjeong-gu, Busandaehak-ro — near PNU campus gate. Experienced with international students.
Hwang-Geum Real Estate (■■ ■■■)	Geumjeong-gu, Geumgang-ro — PNU area. English assistance available.
YES Real Estate (YES ■■■)	Busanjin-gu, Jeonpo-dong — Seomyeon transit hub.
2030 Real Estate (2030 ■■■)	Busanjin-gu, Bujeon-ro — Seomyeon. Specialises in young renter clientele.
Dong-baek Real Estate (■■ ■■■)	Nam-gu Campus Corridor — Kyungsung/Pukyong area.

■ DAEGU — Budget-Friendly, Significant Nepali Population

Daegu is Korea's 4th largest city and one of the most affordable for students. It hosts Kyungpook National University (KNNU), Yeungnam University, and Daegu University — all popular with Nepali students. Rents are 30–45% lower than Seoul.

Buk-gu (■■) — Kyungpook Area	Near KNNU. High density of student one-rooms. Deposit ■500K–■3M, Rent ■250K–■450K (NPR 25K–45K/month).
Dalseong-gun / Dasa Area	Near Yeungnam University campus. Very affordable. Deposit ■500K–■2M, Rent ■200K–■400K (NPR 20K–40K/month).
Jung-gu (■■) — Dongseong-ro	City centre. More expensive. Lively area good for socialising. Rent ■400K–■700K.
Daegu Tips	Daegu's Nepali community is active — contact Daegu University or KNNU's international office for their Nepali student WhatsApp/KakaoTalk groups.

■ DAEJEON & INCHEON — University-Heavy, Very Affordable

Daejeon — Yuseong-gu	Home to KAIST and Chungnam National University. Budget-friendly. Deposit ■500K–■3M. Rent ■250K–■500K (NPR 25K–50K/month). University dorms are excellent here.
Incheon — Yeonsu-gu	Near Incheon National University and close to the airport. More affordable than Seoul despite proximity. Good transport links.
Jeonju / Gwangju / Pohang	For students at Jeonbuk National, Chonnam National, or POSTECH. Very affordable cities with low deposit requirements. Monthly rent can be as low as NPR 20K–35K.

■ DEPOSIT DEDUCTION WARNING — The #1 Problem for Nepali Students

■ READ THIS SECTION VERY CAREFULLY

This is the MOST IMPORTANT section of this guide. The single most common housing problem reported by international students in Korea — including many Nepali students — is the landlord refusing to return the full deposit, or deducting large amounts for dubious 'damages' and 'cleaning fees' when you move out. Many foreigners never get their full deposit back. This section tells you exactly how to protect yourself.

How Landlords Unfairly Deduct From Your Deposit

Under Korean law, landlords can only deduct from your deposit for **damage you caused beyond normal wear and tear**. However, many landlords — especially those who rent to international students — exploit language barriers and unfamiliarity with Korean law to make unfair deductions. Common illegal or questionable deductions include:

Excessive Cleaning Fees	Charging ■200,000–■500,000 for 'professional cleaning' even when the room is left spotlessly clean. ILLEGAL if the room is clean.
Wall Repainting Charges	Charging for repainting the entire room even for minor scuffs that are normal wear and tear. ILLEGAL under standard interpretation.
Appliance 'Repairs'	Claiming appliances you never touched are broken and charging for 'repairs'. A common trick if you have no photo evidence from move-in.
Mold Deductions	Blaming you for mold growth that existed before you moved in or is caused by poor ventilation in the building. Requires your pre-move-in photos to disprove.
Utility Bill Disputes	Adding mysterious unpaid utility charges that were never discussed. Always get a final bill before moving out.
Late Notice Penalties	Charging for 'early notice' even if you gave 30–60 days notice as required. Check your contract's notice period carefully.
Full Deposit Non-Return	In Jeonse-type arrangements, landlords who have invested the deposit may be unable to return it due to financial difficulties — a crisis affecting ~20,000 cases per year in Korea.

Your 10-Step Deposit Protection System — MANDATORY

Step 1 BEFORE SIGNING:	Check the ■■■■■■ (Property Register) at the local court or online (iros.go.kr). Confirm the landlord's name matches their ID. Check for large mortgages in the ■■ (Eul-gu) section. If the mortgage is larger than your deposit, DO NOT rent there — you will lose your deposit if the owner defaults.
Step 2 BEFORE SIGNING:	Request the contract in BOTH Korean and English, or have a trusted Korean speaker translate every clause. Specifically check: exact deposit return timeline, deduction terms (they must be specific, not vague), and notice period required.
Step 3 BEFORE SIGNING:	Never accept vague language like 'deductions at landlord's discretion' in the contract. If you see this, cross it out and write specific terms, or walk away.
Step 4 ON MOVE-IN DAY:	Photograph and video EVERYTHING before unpacking. Every wall, floor, ceiling, appliance, window, door. Include timestamps. Upload immediately to Google Drive/cloud storage.
Step 5 ON MOVE-IN DAY:	Write a damage report listing every existing scratch, stain, scuff, or broken item. Send this to the landlord via KakaoTalk or text message — a written record with a timestamp that they cannot dispute later.
Step 6 ON MOVE-IN DAY:	Take your signed contract to the local ■■■■■■ (Jumin Senteo/Community Center) the SAME DAY. Get the ■■■■■■ (Hwakjeong-ilja) Fixed Date Stamp. This legally protects your deposit even if the landlord sells the property or goes bankrupt. Cost: free.
Step 7 ON MOVE-IN DAY:	Register your address (■■■■■ Jeonip Shingo) at the same community center. This is MANDATORY for legal deposit protection under the Housing Lease Protection Act.
Step 8 DURING YOUR STAY:	Report all maintenance issues in writing via text/KakaoTalk, not just verbally. Keep screenshots of all conversations with your landlord. This prevents them claiming damages that were pre-existing or building-related.
Step 9 BEFORE MOVE-OUT:	Clean the room thoroughly. Fill any nail holes. Remove all items. Clean the bathroom, kitchen, and floors. A spotless room is your strongest protection against cleaning fee deductions.
Step 10 ON MOVE-OUT DAY:	Do a walkthrough with your landlord present. Take photos again. Request your deposit return IN WRITING with a specific date (must be within 30 days under Korean law). If they refuse in person, send a formal text with your bank account number and the legal 30-day deadline.

If Your Landlord Refuses to Return Your Deposit

Do NOT panic. You have legal rights. Take these steps in order:

- Send a formal certified letter (■■■■■ - Naeyong Jeungmyong) to your landlord via the post office. This is a legally recognized written demand that starts the formal process.
- Contact the **Korea Legal Aid Corporation (■■■■■■■■■■)**. They provide FREE legal advice and representation for tenants. Call 132 from any Korean phone — free, and some staff speak basic English.
- Visit your local **Gu-office (■■■)** or **Community Center (■■■■■)** and ask for the Housing Rental Dispute Mediation Committee.
- Contact **HUG (Korea Housing & Urban Guarantee Corporation)** if you purchased Jeonse deposit insurance — they will compensate you and pursue the landlord.
- Contact the **Seoul/Busan/Daegu Foreign Resident Support Center** — free multilingual support for foreign residents with housing disputes.
- Contact **SONSIK (Society of Nepalese Students in Korea)** — they have experience helping Nepali students navigate deposit disputes and can recommend Korean-speaking helpers.
- File a civil lawsuit (■■■■■■■ — Small Claims Court for amounts under ■30M). Court filing fees are minimal and you can represent yourself.

■■ KNOW YOUR LEGAL RIGHT

According to the Housing Lease Protection Act, your landlord **MUST** return your deposit within 30 days of your move-out date (or the contract end date, whichever is later). Deductions must be itemized in writing with receipts. Any deduction without a receipt and written explanation is potentially illegal.

■■ Scam Prevention & Red Flags

■ THE ONE RULE THAT SAVES EVERYTHING

GOLDEN RULE: Never send money via wire transfer, cryptocurrency, or any untraceable method before you or a trusted person has physically walked inside the property and verified ownership documents. No exceptions.

■ The Absent Landlord Scam

Landlord says they are 'working abroad' or 'dealing with a family emergency' and will mail the keys once you transfer the deposit. This is almost certainly a scam. No legitimate landlord operates this way.

■ Impossibly Cheap Listings

Modern, spacious studio next to a prime subway station at half the market price — with beautiful staged photos. The photos are usually stolen from real listings. When you pay, no room exists.

■ High-Pressure Close

Agent or landlord claims 'multiple other people are ready to sign today' and demands a non-refundable cash holding fee over the phone. Legitimate properties do not require instant cash payments before viewing.

■ Ghost Listings (■■■■■)

Listings on Zigbang or Dabang that look perfect but don't actually exist — used to get you to call and visit the agency, where they push you toward inferior rooms. Always call to confirm availability before visiting.

■ Unlicensed 'Agent'

Individuals who claim to be real estate agents but have no license. In Korea, licensed agents display their ■■■■■■ (licensed broker) certificate visibly in their office. Ask to see it.

■ Fake Landlord

Someone signs a contract as if they own the property, collects the deposit, then disappears. The real owner later shows up. Always verify the landlord's ID matches the name on the Property Register (■■■■■).

■ Step-by-Step Timeline for Nepali Students

■ 4–5 Months Before Departure (From Nepal)	Apply for university dormitory IMMEDIATELY after receiving acceptance letter. Contact your university's international office — request their off-campus housing database. Join SONSIK Facebook group and your university's Nepali student KakaoTalk group. Begin browsing Zigbang, Dabang, Student.com to understand market prices.
■ 2–3 Months Before Departure	If not offered a dorm, shortlist neighbourhoods near your university. Browse Peter Pan, Enkostay, and Checkmate Korea for available rooms. Do NOT pay any deposit from Nepal without a video call room tour and document verification. Begin saving for your deposit (budget at minimum ■1,000,000 = ~NPR 1 lakh).
■ 1 Month Before Departure	Book temporary accommodation: a gosiwon, guesthouse, or Airbnb for your first 1–2 weeks in Korea. This gives you time to find a proper room in person. Do NOT sign a long-term lease or transfer a large deposit without physically seeing the room.
■ Week 1 in Korea (Upon Arrival)	Check into your temporary accommodation. Visit your university and connect with your international buddy or Nepali seniors. Walk the neighbourhoods near campus with a Korean-speaking friend. Visit several Budongsan offices. Take photos of every room you visit.
■ Week 2 in Korea	Shortlist your top 1–2 rooms. Verify the ■■■■■■ (Property Register) for each. Negotiate deposit and rent. Sign the contract with a Korean speaker present or use a translation service. Pay your deposit via official bank transfer — NEVER cash.
■ Move-In Day (CRITICAL)	Photograph everything before unpacking. Send damage report to landlord via text. Register your address at the Jumin Senteo (■■■■■). Get your ■■■■■ (Fixed Date Stamp). Set a calendar reminder 2 months before your lease ends to begin deposit return discussions.

Monthly Budget Planner for Nepali Students (Approximate)

Expense	Gosiwon	One-Room Villa (Budget City)	One-Room Seoul	In NPR (Seoul)
Rent	■200K–■400K	■250K–■450K	■400K–■700K	NPR 40K–70K
Management Fee	Included	■20K–■50K	■50K–■150K	NPR 5K–15K
Utilities (Elec/Gas/Water)	Included	■50K–■100K	■80K–■150K	NPR 8K–15K
Internet	Included	■20K–■35K	■30K–■40K	NPR 3K–4K
Food (home cooking)	■150K–■250K	■150K–■250K	■200K–■350K	NPR 20K–35K
Transport (T-Money)	■50K–■100K	■50K–■100K	■60K–■120K	NPR 6K–12K
TOTAL ESTIMATE	■450K–■750K ~NPR 45K–75K	■540K–■985K ~NPR 54K–98K	■820K–■1.46M ~NPR 82K–146K	Budget ■1M–■1.5M/month for Seoul

Note: 1 KRW $\approx$ 0.10–0.11 NPR (verify current rate before budgeting). The Korean minimum wage in 2025 is ■10,030/hour. Working 20 hrs/week (legal limit during semester), you can earn ~■800,000–■1,000,000/month to help cover living costs.

■■ Nepali Community Resources & Emergency Contacts

Community Organizations

SONSIK	Society of Nepalese Students in Korea. ~12,000 Facebook followers. Primary organization for Nepali students. Events during Dashain, Tihar, Buddha Jayanti.	<i>Facebook: SONSİK / npsonsik</i>
Nepalese Community in Busan (NCB)	For Busan-based Nepali students and workers. Active Facebook group for housing, jobs, and community events.	<i>Facebook: Nepalese Community in Busan</i>
Nepali Students in South Korea	General Facebook group for all Nepali students across Korea. Post housing needs here.	<i>Facebook: Search 'Nepali Students in South Korea'</i>
Embassy of Nepal in Seoul	For passport renewals, notarization, emergency assistance, and community events.	<i>Tel: +82-2-379-2457 Location: Seoul, Mapo-gu</i>

Emergency & Legal Help Numbers in Korea

Emergency (Police/Fire/Ambulance)	112 / 119 — Works from any phone, 24/7.
Foreigner Help Line	1345 — Korea Immigration Service helpline. Free. Some Nepali/Hindi assistance.
Korea Legal Aid Corporation	132 — Free legal advice for tenants in deposit disputes. Available nationwide.
Seoul Foreign Resident Center	+82-2-2229-4900 — Support for foreign residents with housing and legal issues.
HUG (Deposit Insurance)	1566-9009 — Korea Housing & Urban Guarantee Corporation for deposit protection queries.
Rental Dispute Mediation	Visit your local Gu-office (■■■). Free mediation service for landlord-tenant disputes.

■ Money-Saving Strategies Specific to Nepali Students

Choose Villa over Officetel	Low-rise residential villas (빌라) have management fees of ₩20K–₩50K versus ₩100K–₩200K for high-rise officetels. Over 12 months, this saves ₩600K–₩1.8M (NPR 60K–180K).
The 2-Stop Subway Radius Rule	Living 1–2 subway stops from your university campus instead of directly adjacent drops rent by 10–20%. The extra 10-minute commute saves NPR 5K–15K every month.
Jik-georae (직거래) — Direct Deals	Find rooms directly from departing students via Peter Pan (피터팬) or SONSIK Facebook — you skip the Bokbi (보끼) agent fee entirely, saving 0.3–0.9% of the deposit.
Add to Deposit, Reduce Rent	The 'Deposit-to-Rent Lever': every extra ₩5,000,000 added to the deposit reduces monthly rent by ~₩30K–₩50K. If you can borrow from family, a higher deposit = lower monthly payment.
Share with Other Nepali Students	Split a 2-room or 3-room apartment with 1–2 other Nepali students. Each person pays 40–60% of what a solo studio would cost. Coordinate through SONSIK or your university group.
Cook Nepali Food at Home	Korean grocery stores stock lentils (콩), rice, vegetables, and spices. Cooking Nepali dal-bhat at home costs ₩3,000–₩5,000 per meal vs ₩7,000–₩15,000 eating out. Saves NPR 15K–25K monthly.
Use T-Money Card for Transport	Buy a T-Money card (available at any convenience store) for buses and subways. Transfer discounts within 30 minutes between subway and bus. Far cheaper than taxis.
Apply for GIST/GKS Scholarship Housing	KGSP (Korean Government Scholarship Program) covers tuition, accommodation, and a monthly living stipend of ₩900,000. This eliminates housing cost concerns entirely. Apply every February–March through the Korean Embassy in Kathmandu.

Final Checklist Before Signing Any Lease

- Verified the 부동산 (Property Register) — owner's name matches, no excessive mortgage
- Landlord's ID matches the name on the Property Register
- Contract reviewed by a Korean speaker or translation service
- No vague deduction clauses ('at landlord's discretion') in the contract

- Deposit + management fee + utilities are clearly defined in the contract
- Move-in and move-out dates are explicitly stated
- Early termination clause understood (notice period and penalties)
- Deposit return timeline written in contract (30 days is the legal maximum)
- Paid deposit via official bank transfer with a receipt — NOT cash
- Took date-stamped photos of every room on move-in day
- Sent damage report to landlord via text/KakaoTalk on move-in day
- Registered address at ■■■■ (Jumin Senteo) on move-in day
- Obtained ■■■■ (Fixed Date Stamp) at ■■■■ on move-in day
- Set calendar reminder 2 months before lease end to discuss deposit return

This guide was compiled using current Korean housing law, Nepali student community resources, and housing platform data as of 2025–2026. Always verify current rental prices and legal procedures with your university's international office or a licensed Korean real estate professional. Exchange rates and prices are approximate — check current rates before budgeting.

■■■■■■■■■! (Shubhakamana!) — Best of luck with your studies in South Korea. ■■■■